

## OBJECTIVE # 2

### Enabling BitLocker and Configuring Recovery

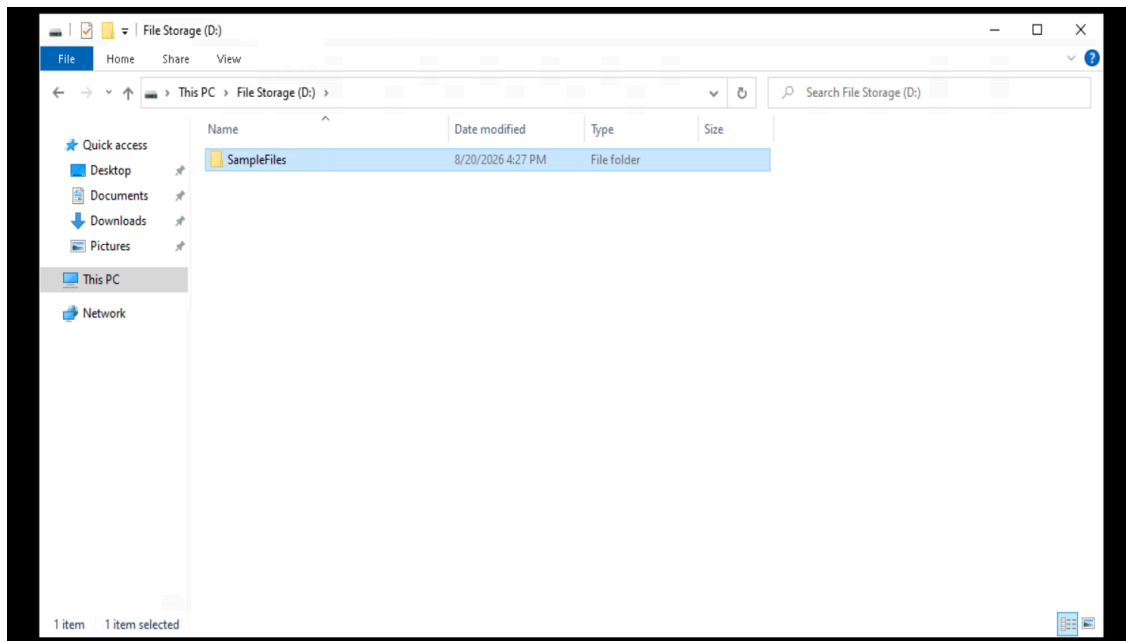
In this lab, I enabled BitLocker encryption on the D: drive to protect the data stored on the drive from unauthorized access. I also configured a password and created a recovery key so that I would have a way to regain access to the encrypted drive if needed.

### Copy Files to the New Drive

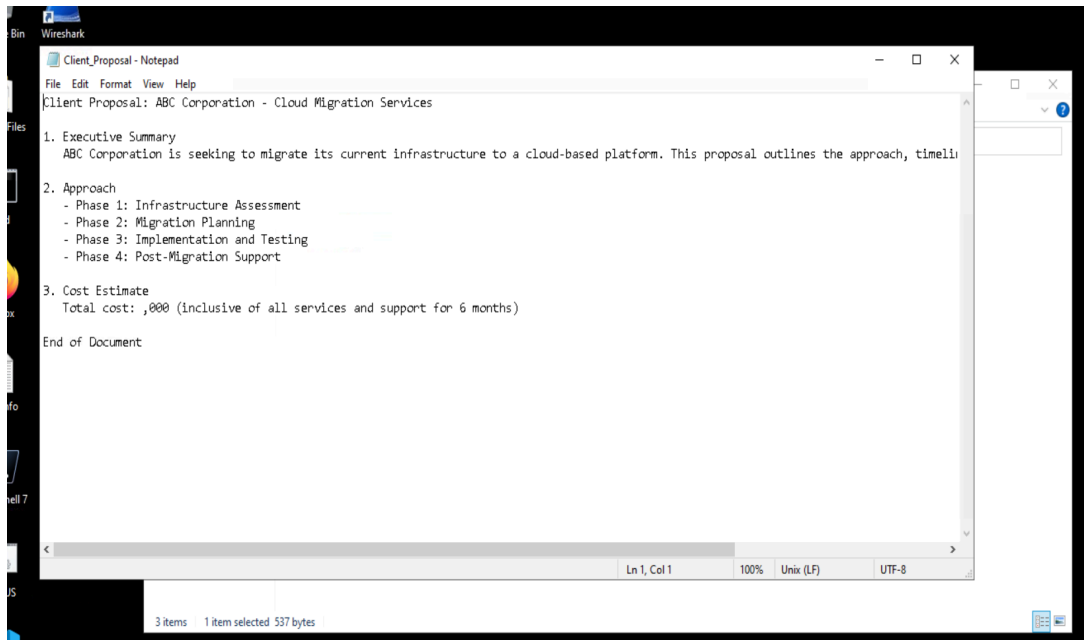
1. I went to the Windows Desktop and located the SampleFiles folder that was created when the lab environment was provisioned. The folder contained three text files.

I right-clicked the folder and selected Copy.

2. I opened File Explorer from the taskbar, selected This PC, and double-clicked the D: drive to open it.
3. I right-clicked an empty area inside the D: drive and selected Paste to copy the SampleFiles folder onto the drive.



I opened the SampleFiles folder and double-clicked one of the text files to open it in Notepad.



- confirmed that I could open the file and then closed Notepad. The contents of the files
- weren't important for this lab.

## Enable BitLocker Encryption

- I clicked the Start icon, typed bitlocker, and selected Manage BitLocker.

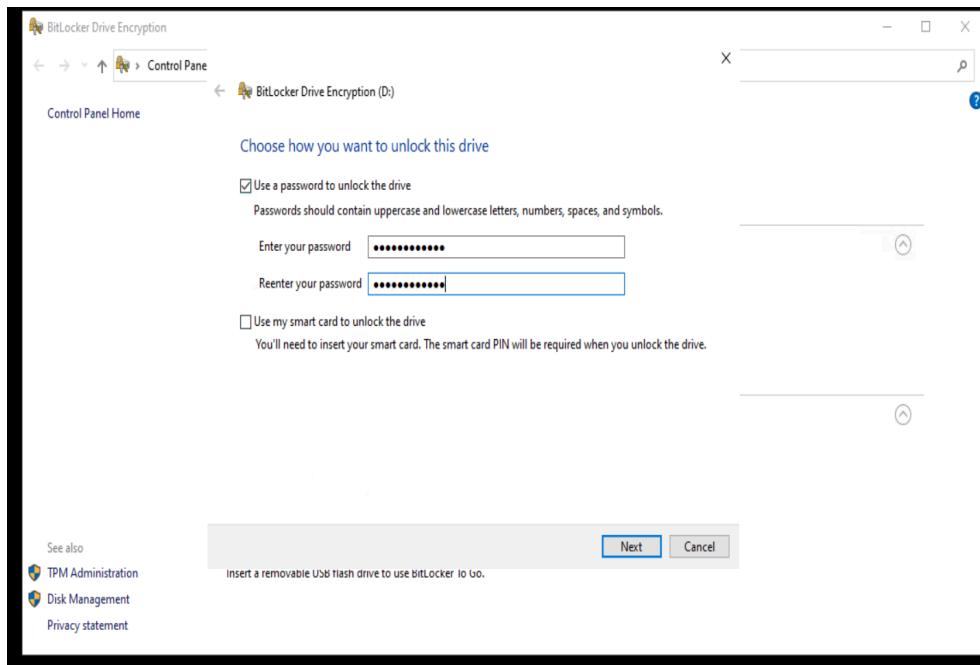
Note: BitLocker is a Windows Server feature that had already been enabled when the lab environment was provisioned.

- I expanded the Fixed data drives section and selected Turn on BitLocker next to the D: drive.

Note: BitLocker can also be enabled on the operating system C: drive, but for this lab I focused on protecting the additional fixed data drive.

- On the unlock method screen, I selected Use a password to unlock the drive.

4. I entered Password123! as the password and clicked Next.



Note: For an actual system, I would use a strong, random, and unique password rather than a simple lab password.

5. On the recovery key options screen, I selected Save to a File.
6. In the Save BitLocker recovery key as dialog box, I selected Desktop from the left-hand side.

I left the automatically generated file name unchanged and clicked Save. This recovery key would be used in the next challenge.

Note: In a real-world environment, I would store the recovery key in a secure location separate from the computer being encrypted. A Microsoft Account can also be used to securely store a recovery key online.

7. I clicked Next to continue after successfully backing up the recovery key. On the encryption options screen, I selected Encrypt used disk space only and clicked Next.

Note: This option encrypts only the data currently stored on the drive, which makes the encryption process faster. Encrypt entire drive would be more appropriate for a drive that previously contained sensitive data because it also encrypts unused space.

8. On the encryption mode screen, I confirmed that New encryption mode (best for fixed drives on this device) was selected and clicked Next.

9. I reviewed the BitLocker configuration summary and clicked Start encrypting.

The encryption completed quickly because there was only a small amount of data on the drive.

After encryption was enabled, I noticed several BitLocker management options were available, including options to back up the recovery key, change the password, and turn off BitLocker.

10. I opened File Explorer and selected This PC.

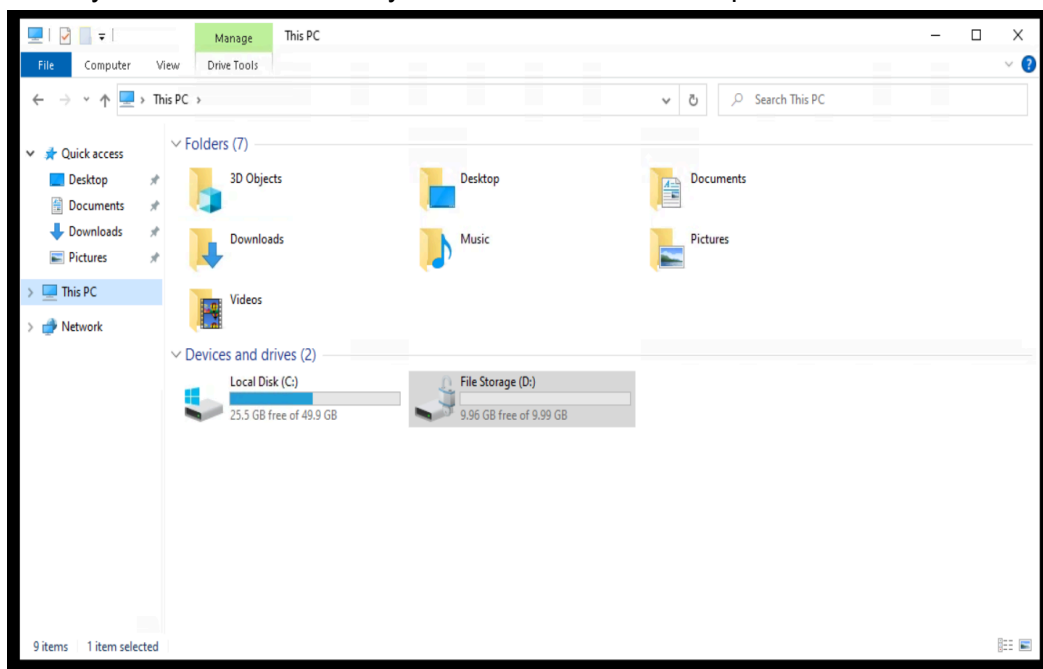
11. Under Devices and drives, I located the D: drive and noticed that a padlock icon was now displayed on the drive in an unlocked state.

This confirmed that BitLocker was enabled on the D: drive. The drive was currently unlocked, so I could still access the files normally.

I also noticed that the C: drive did not have a padlock icon because I had not enabled BitLocker on that drive.

12. I double-clicked the D: drive and opened one of the text files inside the SampleFiles folder.

I confirmed that I could open the file, made a change to its contents, and saved the file to verify that I could still modify data while the BitLocker-protected drive was unlocked.



The D: drive was successfully protected with BitLocker, and the data stored on the drive was encrypted. Because the drive was currently unlocked, I could still access and modify the files normally. In the next challenge, I would test what happens when the drive is locked and use different methods to unlock it and regain access to the data.